

Placement Simulator - Interview Report

Role: SDE

Category: system-design

Difficulty: easy

Scores

overall: 71/100

technical: 65/100

communication: 70/100

confidence: 80/100

problemSolving: 60/100

coding: 0/100

Strengths

- Demonstrated clear understanding of relational vs. document database trade offs, including ACID properties and join capabilities.
- Provided concise, correct API design principles such as meaningful endpoints, proper HTTP methods, consistent request/response formats, and versioning strategy.

Weaknesses

- Did not answer the URL shortener design question, leaving a key part of the interview unaddressed.
- Lacked depth in problem solving: no decomposition of requirements, trade off analysis, or discussion of scalability, fault tolerance, or performance considerations.
- Missing discussion of non functional requirements (e.g., latency, availability, security) for the URL shortener.

Suggestions

- Practice answering all interview questions fully, ensuring each component (functional, non functional, trade offs) is covered.
- When asked to design a system, start with high level requirements, then break them into sub systems, evaluate trade offs, and justify technology choices.
- Include considerations for scaling, caching, consistency models, and monitoring in future responses.

Summary

The candidate shows solid foundational knowledge of database selection and API design principles but failed to address the URL shortener question and did not provide a deep, structured problem solving approach. Strengths lie in clear, correct statements about relational databases and API best practices. Weaknesses include incomplete coverage of the interview prompts and lack of depth in system design reasoning. Focus on practicing full answers, decomposition, and trade off analysis will improve overall performance.